

- Hello and welcome to Applying Functional Medicine in Clinical Practice. I am your host, Dr. Kelechi Uduhiri, and I'm excited to bring to you today a brief introduction of what you're about to learn in this module. I have no financial disclosures to share, and I want us to remember that this is a very brief overview of our introductory course, Applying Functional Medicine in Clinical Practice. There will be an increased emphasis on clinical indicators and ATMs, which are antecedence triggers of mediators of chronic inflammation, especially diet, lifestyle, and the gut. There will be a decreased emphasis on the mechanisms and components of the immune response, and there'll be an increased emphasis on first, food first, then lifestyle, and then gut interventions that can mitigate inflammation. So this right here is the clinical method, and you will be using this framework in your clinical practice of functional medicine. Briefly, it's called GOTOIT. You gather information, you organize that information, you tell the story back to the patient to build that therapeutic relationship, to build that alliance on their wellness journey. You put things in order, in order of, you know, which will come first, which investigations will come first. Then you initiate your treatment plan, and then you track the progress of your interventions. You track your patient's progress. This is the general framework that we use in functional medicine. And as you go through this course, you are gonna, you know, dig deeper into each of these elements. Okay? So again, we do have a toolkit item, that GOTOIT model, where the sequence of steps that are used in the practice of functional medicine will be further delineated. So what is the foundational therapeutic approach? It's lifestyle, lifestyle, lifestyle first, then food first, I call it food as medicine, and it's understanding that you can start your patient with a phyto or the core plan. Again, these are very foundational meal plans for our patients that you can again, grab in the toolkit. And then after food first, it is gut first, then there's the matrix. This is another level of organizing the information that you gather with the patient. It's a way of looking at the clinical imbalances and the physiological dysfunctions that you may be seeing through your investigations. And then you get to place that information on this functional medicine matrix. So let's dive a little deeper. On the left panel, you see the patient's story. Again, the story includes what was inherited, what was acquired. We call those the antecedence. Then the triggers or the events that sort of, you know, get the disease process going. And then the mediators, what keeps things going. So we start there and then we look at that bottom of that functional medicine matrix, which is the modifiable lifestyle factors, sleep, physical activity, nutrition, stressors, relationships. How do these impact the lived experience? Then we will go through each of the nodes in the matrix. Assimilation, where you'll learn about that dig in model, the therapeutic of the five R approach. Again, I'm just giving you teasers, you'll learn a little bit deeper, more into all these areas. You know, chronic inflammation will fall into defense and repair. You know, in the communication node, how does chronic stress, how does adrenal dysregulation affect how the body communicates between these

various systems? When we come to the transport node, we're looking at a cardiometabolic dysfunction, right? Hypertension, heart disease, diabetes, all these aspects of the patient's condition affect this node. Then we look at, you know, the mitigation and clearance of toxins. How do we avoid toxins? How do we clear toxins? Very important. In the energy node, we look at the mitochondrial dysfunction. Now, this is very important because we know that mitochondria is a powerhouse of energy, right? So when it malfunctions, a lot of things can go wrong, and so we will learn more about that, okay? And the structural integrity, muscles, joints, tendons, cartilages, you know, how does all this come together to improve or impact the lived experience of the patient? And the epicenter of this matrix is, of course, mental, emotional, spiritual. You know, we cannot put this aside. We cannot forget that this is part of what makes the patient either have a good lived experience or a very poor one. So this is all part of the matrix. So I welcome you to Applying Functional Medicine in Clinical Practice. You are gonna have so much fun in this module, I guarantee it. And please do not hesitate to be part of those clinical forums to ask questions of your educators and our IFM moderators. Again, I welcome you, wish you all the best and I'll see you soon, thank you.